Arabic Grammar for Understanding Quraan[1] Part VI

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[1] This tutorial has been prepared primarily from NAK Dreamprogram and other Textbooks

Chapter Outline

Incomplete Verbs

Incomplete Verb كَانَ

Incomplete Verb لَيْسَ

Compound إِسْم

Incomplete Verbs أَفْعَالَ نَاقِصَة

- Following verbs are **incomplete** without the next word/words:

–	Present/Future	Past	Meaning
1	يَكُونُ	كَانَ	To be —
2	يُصْبِحُ	أَصْبَحَ	To become —
3	لَيْسَ	—	Is not —
4	يَظَلُّ	ظَلَّ	To remain —

- They are also called كَانَ وَ أَخَوَاتُهَا or simply **كَانَ and her sisters**

Incomplete Verbs أَفْعَالَ نَاقِصَة Cont.1

- Recall, in Noun-based Sentence or الْجُمْلَةُ الاسْمِيَّة there is an **invisible IS**
  Example: ٱللَّهُ غَفُورٌ Allah **is** pardoning.
  Notes:
  - ✓ Here **ٱللَّهُ is the مُبْتَدَأٌ** or early subject which must either مَرْفُوعٌ ✓(or حرف النصب)
  - ✓ And **غَفُورٌ is the خَبَرْ** or late subject which is always مَرْفُوعٌ
- Now if we want to speak like "Allah was pardoning" or "Allah has been always pardoning".
  Basically we are shifting it to past tense.
  Or we want to say "Allah will be always pardoning" shifting to Future Tense.
- In present
  tense there is no seperate word for "IS" but in past and future tense there are seperate words (i.e. verb).
  Suprisingly these sentences are also noun-based sentences or الْجُمْلَةُ الاسْمِيَّة even if they have verbs.

Incomplete Verb كَانَ Example

- Consider the following الْجُمْلَةُ الاسْمِيَّة

اَلْأُسْتَاذُ مَوْجُودٌ	The teacher is present

Here اَلْأُسْتَاذُ is the مُبْتَدَأْ or early subject and مَوْجُودٌ is the خَبَرْ or late subject

- Now we will make it a **past tense**. "The teacher was present"
- The arabic sentence will be:

كَانَ اَلْأُسْتَاذُ مَوْجُودًا	The teacher was present

Incomplete Verb كَانَ Example 1

كَانَ ٱلْأُسْتَاذُ مَوْجُودًا	The teacher was present

Few Points:

- Here كَانَ ٱلْأُسْتَاذُ (i.e. كَانَ+ Doer) together will form its مُبتَدَأٌ or early subject. And the **Doer will be always مَرْفُوعٌ** (i.e. ٱلْأُسْتَاذُ is مَرْفُوعٌ)
- مَوْجُودًا is its خَبَرْ or late subject **which is normally مَرْفُوعٌ but in this case it must be a مَنْصُوبٌ**
- The Doer (i.e. ٱلْأُسْتَاذُ) is called **إِسْم of كَانَ** while the مَوْجُودًا is called **خَبَرْ of كَانَ**
- <u>In summary</u> **إِسْم of كَانَ is always مَرْفُوعٌ** and **خَبَرْ of كَانَ is always مَنْصُوبٌ**

Incomplete Verb كَانَ Example 2

Basic Version	ٱللَّهُ عَلِيمٌ حَكِيمٌ	Allah is the knowing and knowledgeable
Basic Version2	إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ عَلِيمٌ حَكِيمٌ	Surely Allah is the knowing and knowledgeable Here إِنَّ ٱللَّهَ is a حرف النصب and its مُبتَدَأٌ
Past Version	كَانَ ٱللَّهُ عَلِيمًا حَكِيمًا	Allah has been always the knowing and knowledgeable

Note: The meaning of كَانَ in the context of ٱللَّهُ ﷻ becomes **"has been always"**

Incomplete Verb كَانَ Example 3

- Case I: مُبتَدَأٌ is an **Independent Pronoun**

Basic Version	هُوَ عَلِيمٌ	He is knowledgeable
Past Version	كَانَ عَلِيمًا	He was knowledgeable

- Case II: Present Tense. Rules remain same.

Basic Version	ٱلْمُعَلِّمُ مُسَافِرٌ	The teacher is a traveler
Future Version	يَكُونُ ٱلْمُعَلِّمُ مُسَافِرًا	The teacher will be a traveler i.e. the teacher will be traveling

Note: In case of كَانَ the inside doer or pronoun is already inside the verb just like نَصَرَ has the doer "HE" in it.

Incomplete Verb كَانَ Outside and Inside Doer

- Rule for Outside Doer and Inside (embedded) Doer is same i.e. **for outside doer the verb will take its he/she form** (no matter of the number of actual doer)

Basic Version (Present)	هُمْ صَالِحُونَ	They are righteous
Inside Doer (Past)	كَانُواْ صَالِحِينَ	They **were** righteous
Basic Version (Present)	ٱلْمُسْلِمُونَ صَالِحُونَ	The muslims are righteous
Outside Doer (Past)	كَانَ ٱلْمُسْلِمُونَ صَالِحِينَ	The muslims **were** righteous

Note: In case of Outside Doer, even the doer is plural (ٱلْمُسْلِمُونَ i.e. The Muslims) the sentence begins with a singular verb كَانَ (i.e. هُوَ from)

Verb Conjugation of كَانَ

- Present Tense الْفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ

مضارع

هُوَ يَكُوْنُ	هُما يَكُوْنانِ	هُمْ يَكُوْنُوْنَ
هِيَ تَكُوْنُ	هُما تَكُوْنانِ	هُنَّ يَكُنَّ
أَنْتَ تَكُوْنُ	أَنْتُما تَكُوْنانِ	أَنْتُمْ تَكُوْنُوْنَ
أَنْتِ تَكُوْنِيْنَ	أَنْتُما تَكُوْنانِ	أَنْتُنَّ تَكُنَّ
أَنا أَكُوْنُ		نَحْنُ نَكُوْنُ

Figure 1: Present Conjugation of كَانَ

- Past Tense الْفِعْلُ الْمَاضِي

ماض

هُوَ كانَ	هُما كانا	هُمْ كانُوْا
هِيَ كانَتْ	هُما كانَتا	هُنَّ كُنَّ
أَنْتَ كُنْتَ	أَنْتُما كُنْتُما	أَنْتُمْ كُنْتُمْ
أَنْتِ كُنْتِ	أَنْتُما كُنْتُما	أَنْتُنَّ كُنْتُنَّ
أَنا كُنْتُ		نَحْنُ كُنَّا

Figure 2: Past Conjugation of كَانَ

كَانَ خَبَرْ May be Scattered

- Earlier we have learned that the كَانَ+Doer together form its مُبتَدَأْ (or Early Subject) and they are next to each other. But in many cases **the Doer may be far away from its كَانَ verb**. It happens mostly with posessives (لَهُ):
  Example:

Basic Version	لَهُ كِتَابٌ	He has a book
Past Version	كَانَ لَهُ كِتَابٌ	He had a book

Note: Here كَانَ + كِتَابٌ together form its مُبتَدَأْ although they are not next to each other. And لَهُ is its مُتَعَلِّق بِا لخَبرَ The sentence has no خَبَرْ , so no room to change to its مَنْصُوبٌ status.

- **The meaning of كَانَ:** Normally it is translated as "WAS" but at the same time it conveys the meaning of "ACTUALLY" in general and "HAS BEEN ALWAYS" particularly for ٱللَّهُ
  Example: وَكَانَ اللَّهُ غَفُورًا رَّحِيمًا **And ever is Allah Forgiving and Merciful.** 25:70 part

Incomplete Verb لَيْسَ

- لَيْسَ means **"it/he is not"**
- Unlike كَانَ **it has only one form** i.e. no form for other tenses.
- Lets begin with the following Basic Example. There are **4 ways** to add negative meaning to it (i.e. The house is not big).

Basic Version	ٱلْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ	The house is big

Negative Sentence with لَيْسَ Option 1 and 2

Basic Version	ٱلْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ	The house is big

- Option 1: Normal way to make a Sentence Negative
  Option 2: Add ب

Option 1	كَبِيرًا	لَيْسَ ٱلْبَيْتُ	The house is NOT big
Labels	خَبَرْ	مُبتَدَأْ	
Option 2	بِكَبِيرٍ	لَيْسَ ٱلْبَيْتُ	The house is NOT big AT ALL
Labels	خَبَرْ	مُبتَدَأْ	

- Note for Option 2:
  - ✓ بِكَبِيرٍ is a جار و مَجرُور and it is the خَبَرْ here. ب **adds emphasis**. The sentence has no مُتَعَلِّق بِا لخَبرَ

Negative Sentence with لَيْسَ Option 2 Example

At-Tin 95:8

أَلَيْسَ ٱللَّهُ بِأَحْكَمِ ٱلْحَٰكِمِينَ ﴿٨﴾

Is not Allah the Best of the judges???

- The rhetorical question has been emphasised by the use of ب which strongly states that "No doubt Allah is the best of the judges"

Negative Sentence with مَا Option 3 and 4

Basic Version	ٱلْبَيْتُ كَبِيرٌ	The house is big

- Option 1: Use مَا for higher emphasis
  Option 2: Use مَا and ب to further emphasize

Option 3	كَبِيرًا	مَا ٱلْبَيْتُ	No, actually the house is NOT big
Labels	خَبَرْ	مُبتَدَأْ	
Option 4	بِكَبِيرٍ	مَا ٱلْبَيْتُ	No,the house is NOT big AT ALL
Labels	خَبَرْ	مُبتَدَأْ	

- Note for Option 3 and 4:
  - ✓ The use of مَا is used to **correct somebody**, adding ب further strengthens it. Option 4 , thus, reflects **the highest level** of a negative statement used for refutation.

Negative Sentence with لَيْسَ Option 4 Example

Al-Baqara 2:74 part

وَ مَا ٱللَّهُ بِغَٰفِلٍ عَمَّا تَعْمَلُونَ

And in no way Allah is unaware about what you do.

- The statement has been highly emphasized by the use of مَا and ب together which very strongly states that "No doubt, surely Allah is aware of what you do"

Incomplete Verb لَيْسَ (and مَا) Example

- Lets observe the following general example in **4 different ways**:

Labels→	خَبَرْ	مُبتَدَأْ	
Option 1	طَالِبًا	لَسْتُ	I am not a student
Option 2	بِطَالِبٍ	لَسْتُ	I am NOT a student AT ALL.
Option 3	طَالِبًا	مَا أَنَا	No,I am NOT a student.
Option 4	بِطَالِبٍ	مَا أَنَا	No,I am NOT a student AT ALL.

- Note for Option 3 and 4:

  Since مَا does not have the embedded doer (i.e. inside doer like لَيْسَ) explicit doer by means of Independent Pronoun أَنَا has been placed here.

مَا + ب Examples from Quran

- IN Quran Allah ﷻ defended His Messenger ﷺ and His message (i.e. Quran) **in the strongest possible way (i.e. using مَا+بِ format)** in Sura At-Takwir (81)

Sura At-Takwir 81

وَ مَا صَاحِبُكُم بِمَجْنُونٍ ﴿٢٢﴾

And indeed your companion (i.e.Prophet ﷺ) is not a madman (**in any way!!!**) (22)

وَ مَا هُوَ بِقَوْلِ شَيْطَٰنٍ رَّجِيمٍ ﴿٢٥﴾

And it (i.e. Quran) is not the word of the outcast devil (**in any way!!!**). (25)

Early Subject مُبتَدَأْ Details

- In **Noun-based Sentence** or الْجُمْلَةُ الاسْمِيَّة the **subject is called مُبتَدَأْ** . It is also called Early Subject as it has another subject called Late Subject or خَبَرْ
- There are several ways to **recognize مُبتَدَأْ** in a Noun-based Sentence or الْجُمْلَةُ الاسْمِيَّة

  i. A proper noun or إِسْم which is مَرْفُوعٌ

  Example: وَ ٱللَّهُ بَصِيرُۢ بِٱلْعِبَادِ And **Allah** is All-Seer of His slaves. 3:15 part

  ii. إِنَّ+ its victim (in general حرف النصب and its victim)

  Example: إِنَّ رَبَّكَ عَلِيمٌ حَكِيمٌ **Verily your Lord** is All-Knowing, All-Wise. 12:6 part

Recognizing مُبتَدَأْ Cont.1

- Recognize مُبتَدَأْ
  - iii. Independent Pronouns (i.e. هُوَ هُمْ) Recall they are always مَرْفُوعٌ

    Example: وَ هُوَ ٱلْعَزِيزُ ٱلْحَكِيمُ And **He** is the All-Mighty, the All-Wise. 59:24 part
  - iv. Unaffected Pointers (example ذَٰلِكَ تِلْكَ هَٰذِهِۦ) i.e. when they come without any other particle before them like فِي أَلَا

    Example: هَٰذِهِۦ جَهَنَّمُ **this** is Hell 55:43 part
  - v. كَانَ and her Sisters

    Example: وَ كَانَ ٱللَّهُ غَفُورًا رَّحِيمًا and **Allah is always** oft-forgiving, most merciful 25:70 part

Multiple مُبتَدَأْ A Tool to emphasize

- Consider the following example:

Basic Affirmative	هُوَ أُسْتَاذٌ He is a teacher

- We can say in Arabic **"Surely he, he was a teacher"** The **repetition of the Subject** i.e. **Multiple مُبتَدَأْ removes ambiguity** and **strengthens the claim**.

Multiple مُبتَدَأْ	أُسْتَاذًا	كَانَ	إِنَّهُ
Labels	خَبَرْ of كَانَ	(b) مُبتَدَأْ	(a) مُبتَدَأْ
Meaning	Certainly he, he was a teacher		

Multiple مُبتَدَأْ Example from the Quran

- Multiple مُبتَدَأْ

Example 1		ٱلرَّحِيمُ	ٱلْغَفُورُ	هُوَ	إِنَّهُ
	Labels	(b) خَبَرْ	(a) خَبَرْ	(b) مُبتَدَأْ	(a) مُبتَدَأْ
	Meaning	Certainly He, He is the forgiving, the merciful 39:53 part			
Example 2			ٱلْمُفْلِحُونَ	هُمْ	أُوْلَآئِكَ
	Labels	(b) خَبَرْ	(a) خَبَرْ	(b) مُبتَدَأْ	(a) مُبتَدَأْ
	Meaning	They, they are the successful 2:5 part			

- **Summary:** Multiple مُبتَدَأْ through repeated pronouns (i.e. subject pronouns and/or pointers) is a strong mechanism to remove doubt and thus add emphasis on the claim made.
- **Conversely**, removal of any of the مُبتَدَأْ will still make the sentence correct (with base meaning), so, both إِنَّهُ ٱلْغَفُورُ ٱلرَّحِيمُ and هُوَ ٱلْغَفُورُ ٱلرَّحِيمُ are correct sentences.

كَانَ + Present Tense Verb الْفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ Used To..

- Recall the definition of خَبَرْ (ref. part3 slide 43) can be a complete sentence either الْجُمْلَةُ الاسْمِيَّة or الْجُمْلَةُ الفِعْلِيَّةُ . But in case of كَانَ based sentence, the خَبَرْ can be complete verb-based sentence or الْجُمْلَةُ الفِعْلِيَّةُ only.
- كَانَ + Present Tense Verb الْفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ implies either "**Used to do..**" or "**was doing..**" The context reveals which one to apply. Generally it reflects the meaning of **"Habitual action which was done repeatedly"**
- كَانَ + Past Tense Verb الْفِعْلُ الْمَاضِي is rarely used and implies "something happened very long ago"

كَانَ + Present Tense Verb الْفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ Used To.. Example

- كَانَ + Present Tense Verb الْفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ implies either "**Used to do..**" or "**was doing..**" The context reveals which one to apply. Generally it reflects the meaning of **"Habitual action which was done repeatedly"**
- كَانَ and Present Tense Verb الْفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ must **match Gender and Number**
- **Example:**

وَ لَهُمْ عَذَابٌ أَلِيمٌ بِمَا كَانُو اْ يَكْذِبُونَ

A painful punishment is for them (i.e. hypocrites) because of what **they used to tell lies**. 2:10 part

Note: both كَانُو and يَكْذِبُونَ are Masculine and 3rd Person Plural

كَانَ + الْفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ Used To..More Example

- Example:

فَيُنَبِّئُكُم بِمَا كُنتُمْ تَعْمَلُونَ

then He will inform you about what **you used to do**. 39:7 part

Note: both كُنْتُمْ and تَعْمَلُونَ are Masculine and 2nd Person Plural

مَا كَانَ Templates

مَا كَانَ forms a **Negative Templates** in 2 ways:

i.

Template 1	(Y) — أَنْ (X) — مَا كَانَ لِ
Meaning	It is not appropriate for X to do Y
Example:	وَ مَا كَانَ لَهُمْ أَن يَدْخُلُوهَا
Meaning	It is not appropriate for **them** to **enter** it. 2:114 part

Notes:

- ✓ X is usually a pronoun or a proper name.
- ✓ Y takes its **Light Form** (in present tense) because it comes after أَنْ particle.

مَا كَانَ Templates Cont.

مَا كَانَ forms a **Negative Templates** in 2 ways:

ii.

Template 2	(Y) — لِ (X) — مَا كَانَ
Meaning	X would not be one to do Y
Example:	وَ مَا كَانَ ٱللَّهُ لِيَظْلِمَهُمْ
Meaning	Allah would not be the one **to wrong** them. 9:70 part

Notes:

- ✓ X is usually a proper name.
- ✓ Y takes its **Light Form** (in present tense) because it comes after لِ particle.

Compound إِسْم using أَنْ

- The word أَنْ has 2 meanings:
  a) To b) that
- أَنْ makes the Present Tense Verb الْفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ Light (i.e. مَنْصُوبٌ status of the verb)
- Recall in English Grammar, think of the following sentence:
  Walking is good for health or To walk is good for health.
  In the first case, "Walking" is called Gerund while the in the second sentence "To walk" serves the same purpose using an infinity "to". In both cases they serve as "Noun". In Arabic it is called "Masdar" or Verbal Noun or Compound إِسْم
- Consider the following Arabic Example:
  يَأْكُلُ means "He eats" while أَن يَّأْكُلَ means "To eat"
  The first one is a complete sentence i.e. الْجُمْلَةُ الفِعْلِيَّةُ but the second one expresses "an idea" and it serves as a compound إِسْم or Masdar in Arabic Grammar.

Compound إِسْم using أَنْ

- So, Light version of الْفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ + أَنْ serves as Noun or إِسْم . All roles of an ordinary Noun can be done by this combination as well.
- Examples in Arabic Verbal Sentence الْجُمْلَةُ الفِعْلِيَّةُ :

Example	يُرِيدُ أَن يَّذْهَبَ إِلَى ٱلْمَسْجِدِ
Meaning	He wants **to go to the masjid**.

- In the above example, the phrase أَن يَّذْهَبَ إِلَى ٱلْمَسْجِدِ is replaceable with a Single Noun, hence it is here **Object of the Verb (What) or مَفْعُول بِهِ**

Compound إِسْم using أَنْ

- So, Light version of أَنْ + الْفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ serves as Noun or إِسْم . All roles of an ordinary Noun can be done by this combination as well.
- Examples in Arabic Noun-based Sentence الْجُمْلَةُ الاسْمِيَّة

Example	أَنْ تَصُومُواْ خَيْرٌ لَّكُمْ
Meaning	**That you fast (i.e. Fasting)** is better for you. 2:184 part

- In the above example, the phrase أَنْ تَصُومُواْ appears before "IS" so, it is the **subject or مُبتَدَأْ**

Compound إِسْم using أَنَّ "that"

- Unlike أَنْ this أَنَّ particle normally takes a noun or attached pronoun, does not change verb form to light/lightest. But it makes a long fragment of Noun or Compound إِسْم .
- Example

Example	وَ يَحْسَبُونَ أَنَّهُمْ مُهْتَدُونَ
Meaning	They believe **that they are committed to guidance**

- In the above example, the phrase أَنَّهُمْ مُهْتَدُونَ appears as the object of the verb (WHAT), so it مَفعُولِبِهِ

يَوْمَ إِذَ إِذْ Tense Transformation

New Terms:

New Term	Actual	Expected	Term	Actual	Expected
فِي مَحَلِّ نَصَبْ	Something Else	نَصْب	مَنْصُوبٌ	نَصْب	نَصْب
فِي مَحَلِّ رَفَعْ	Something Else	رَفْع	مَرْفُوعٌ	رَفْع	رَفْع
فِي مَحَلِّ جَرّ	Something Else	جَرّ	مَجْرُورٌ	جَرّ	جَرّ

إِذْ إِذَا يَوْمَ Tense Transformation

There are **two important aspects** of these words or particles:

i. **Grammar Labeling:** They are always مُضَاف no matter what comes after that. The entire sentence or fragment after these words/particles are thus called فِي مَحَلِّ جَرّ.

ii. **Meaning:** These particles shifts the tense as follows (irrespective of the tense of original verb used)

a) إِذْ means **"When"** shifts the context into **Past Tense or الْفِعْلُ الْمَاضِي**

b) إِذَا means **"When"** shifts the context into **Future Tense or الْفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ** (note it covers both present and future, but here it applies only for future)

c) يَوْمَ means **"on the day"** shifts the context into **Future or الْفِعْلُ الْمُضَارِعُ**

يَوْمَ إِذَ إِذْ Example

Affirmative	هُوَ قَآئِمٌ He is standing

(i) إِذْ when in Past	إِذْ هُوَ قَآئِمٌ He was standing
(ii) إِذَ when in Future	إِذَ هُوَ قَآئِمٌ He will be standing
(iii) يَوْمَ when in Future	يَوْمَ هُوَ قَآئِمٌ On the day he will be standing

إِذْ Example From Quran

Required Vocabulary:

يَرْفَعُ	He raises (3rd Masc. Sing,Present Tense)

Recall: إِذْ "when" in Past

إِذْ+Present Tense $\Longrightarrow$ Past Tense	إِذْ يَرْفَعُ إِبْرَٰهِيمُ ٱلْقَوَاعِدَ مِنَ ٱلْبَيْتِ

When Ibrahim raised the foundation of the House... 2:127

إِذْ Example From Quran Cont.

Required Vocabulary:

يَقُولُ	he says (3rd Masc. Sing,Present Tense)	قَالَ	He said (3rd Masc. Sing,Past Tense)

Recall: إِذْ "when" in Past

إِذْ+Present Tense $\Longrightarrow$ Past Tense	إِذْ يَقُولُ ٱلْمُنَٰفِقُونَ وَ ٱلَّذِينَ فِي قُلُوبِهِم مَّرَضٌ
When the hypocrites and those with sickness in their heats said.. 8:49	
إِذْ+Past Tense $\Longrightarrow$ Past Tense	وَ إِذْ قَالَ رَبُّكَ لِلْمَلَٰٓئِكَةِ
When your Lord said to the angels.. 2:30	

إِذَ Example From Quran

Required Vocabulary:

جَآءَ	It came (3rd Masc. Sing, Past Tense)

Recall: إِذَ "when" in Future Tense

إِذَ+Past Tense $\Longrightarrow$ Future Tense	إِذَا جَآءَ نَصْرُ ٱللَّهِ وَ ٱلْفَتْحُ ﴿١﴾
When the help of Allah comes (in future) 110:1	

يَوْمَ Example From Quran

Required Vocabulary:

تَرَى	You see (2nd Masc. Sing, Present Tense)

Recall: يَوْمَ "On the Day" in Future Tense

يَوْمَ+Present Tense $\Longrightarrow$ Future Tense	يَوْمَ تَرَى ٱلْمُؤْمِنِينَ وَ ٱلْمُؤْمِنَٰتِ
On the day (of judgment) you will see the believing man and believing women.. 57:12 part	